THE SEO PLAYBOOK FOR THE AI ERA

What still matters when a machine writes the answer.

AI answers are built from pages a crawler could read. SEO is the entry ticket. This is the part of it that still earns its keep.

EDITION 2026 EVERY NUMBER SOURCED CAL.COM/SOLVX-AI/15MIN

CONTENTS

01 SEO IS THE ENTRY TICKET

02 LET THE CRAWLERS IN

03 LOCAL SEO FOR A CLINIC

04 WHAT TO STOP PAYING FOR

05 QUARTERLY CHECK

Who it is for. Whoever looks after your website and your Google profiles.

Every number names its source; the full list is on the last page. Updated 7 October 2026.

01

SEO IS THE ENTRY TICKET

1B+

people use Google's AI Mode every month. It is now merged with AI Overviews.

Source: Google

20.5%

of Google searches show an AI Overview. For health searches it is 43%.

Source: Ahrefs

> *A page that is not crawled and indexed cannot be quoted. Everything else in this playbook follows from that.*

02

LET THE CRAWLERS IN

Sites drop out of AI answers without anyone deciding they should.

- [ ] robots.txt allows the AI search crawlers: OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, PerplexityBot, Claude-SearchBot, Googlebot and Bingbot.
- [ ] Your CDN is not blocking them. Cloudflare now sorts AI bots into Search, Agent and Training, and new domains block Agent and Training bots by default on pages that show ads.
- [ ] Pages read fully without JavaScript.
- [ ] The generative AI control in Google Search Console is set to include.
- [ ] Bing Webmaster Tools is set up. Its AI Performance report shows your citations in Copilot.

03

LOCAL SEO FOR A CLINIC

45%

of US consumers now use AI tools for local business recommendations. A year earlier it was 6%.

Source: BrightLocal

- A complete Google Business Profile for every location, with services and categories filled in.
- A page per location that answers patient questions, not only an address and a map.
- The same name, address and phone on every profile, to the letter.
- A steady flow of reviews, and a reply to each one.

04

WHAT TO STOP PAYING FOR

- llms.txt sold as a lever. Google says it neither helps nor harms.
- “AI schema” packages. Google says no special schema is needed for its AI features.
- A page for every city and every phrasing. Google treats those as scaled content abuse.
- Rank tracking for AI “positions”. The same question returns the same list of brands less than 1% of the time.

05

QUARTERLY CHECK

- [ ] Fetch your own pages as an AI crawler would. Confirm you get the full text.
- [ ] Open Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools. Read the AI reports.
- [ ] Search each location by name. Fix any profile that disagrees with your site.
- [ ] Update the date and the numbers on your ten most-visited pages.

NEXT STEP

FIFTEEN MINUTES. NO PITCH DECK.

Tell us the questions your patients or buyers ask. We will show you who the AI names for them.

BOOK A CALL

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